

DANIEL OLSHANSKY

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ABOUT ME

Software engineer with 12+ years of experience across artificial intelligence, mixed reality, autonomous vehicles, and consensus & payment protocols, with 3+ years of formal engineering management. My expertise is at the intersection of backend, distributed systems, data, APIs, and tooling, with a focus on bridging research and production. I thrive in zero-to-one environments, clarify ambiguity, adapt to new domains, while architecting & productionizing systems that enable individuals to focus on their strengths.

EXPERIENCE

BreakingGround (Founder, AI Consulting)

2026 - Present

- **Context:** Building on GetSoils (2021 - 2022), a construction-soil marketplace for geotech firms (IP sold).
- **Results:** Part-time AI consulting for geotech: fine-tuning VLMs (Thinking Machines' Tinker) for soil analysis, datasette.io based data exploration, workflow automation, and data governance.

Pocket Network (Head of Protocol) & Grove Labs (CTO)

2022 - May 2026

- **Context:** Rose from Consensus Protocol Engineer to CTO, leading the R&D of a decentralized protocol while coordinating alignment among hundreds of ecosystem stakeholders.
- **Built:** A permissionless API marketplace enabling decentralized data access at scale through a verifiable rate limiter.
- **Impact:** Scaled a \$100M+ protocol serving 1B+ daily requests across hundreds of services, providers, and exchanges.
- **Pivoted:** Handed off the Network to the foundation and built a wallet-first Agentic Payments platform for content creators — thousands of dollars in micropayments across a few dozen true fans, but the market proved too early.

Senior Software Engineer, Planner Eval @ Waymo (Alphabet)

2020 - 2022

- **Context:** Evaluated autonomous vehicle motion planning across real-world, simulated, golden, and adversarial environments at scale.
- **Built:** Reproducible evaluation tooling, labeling infrastructure, golden datasets, and 3D visualization systems for simulation and planner analysis.
- **Impact:** Led the org-wide test set initiative supporting mission-critical safety evals used by 50+ data scientists across 6+ teams and millions of dollars in simulation infrastructure.

Lead Software Engineer, Augmented Reality Cloud @ Magic Leap

2016 - 2020

- **Context:** Founding member of the Magic Leap cloud team building device management infrastructure and the AR cloud.
- **Built:** OTA update systems and cloud infrastructure transforming raw sensor data into object recognition, sparse/dense mapping, and multiplayer localization capabilities.
- **Impact:** Supported thousands of ML1 devices, enabled critical internal research initiatives, contributed to demos raising hundreds of millions of dollars, and co-authored 15+ patents.

Software Engineer @ Twitter

2014 - 2016

- **Context:** First engineering role out of college at a large-scale consumer platform, growing from implementation-focused engineer into full-stack systems builder.
- **Built:** Full-stack features across data pipelines, mobile, web, and backend systems on the VIT and Media teams.
- **Impact:** Shipped GIF search, custom timelines, and vetted account features used by tens of millions of daily users.

EDUCATION

Internships

2011 - 2013

ModiFace 2011 (mobile computer vision), Twitter 2012 (iOS), Google 2013 (Android)

University of Toronto

2010 - 2014

B.A.Sc in Engineering Science, Electrical & Computer Engineering • GPA: 3.84 • Dean's List • NΨ 1T4

Thesis: Accelerating PCA for fMRI analysis using GPUs and MapReduce

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES *(all items below are hyperlinked)*

Writing: Posts, Thoughts, Substack, Medium

Presenting: Talks & Interviews

Consuming: Books, Podcasts, Movies, TV

Publishing: Google Scholar

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Python · Go · Java · Scala · C/C++ · Elixir · iOS · Android · PostgreSQL · SQLite · Datasette · Redis · Kubernetes · GCP · MQTT · MapReduce · Distributed Systems · Consensus Algorithms · API Design · Developer Experience · Agentic Payments · Evals · Data Labeling · Test Sets · VLMs · RAG · Tinker · x402 · Stablecoin · Agentic Infra & Tools